BASELINE → TREATMENT → FOLLOW-UP

Treatment checks across the course

Relative stages, not equally spaced dates. Agree who books each check, reviews results and gives advice if a check is missed.

Check	Before starting	First treatment	During treatment	Phase / dose review	After treatment
Bloods and symptoms	Baseline blood count, kidney and liver checks	Confirm tests and prescription before the first dose	Repeat bloods and symptom checks according to this regimen	Recheck after a hold or treatment change	Follow unresolved effects and the agreed disease-review plan
Treatment review	Confirm exact cancer setting and biomarkers	Explain expected benefit and how it will be assessed	Report new symptoms between visits	Review response, tolerability and active medicines	Agree the next treatment or surveillance plan
Electrolytes and EGFR effects	Check electrolyte and skin-risk plan	Skin care and prompt reaction reporting	Monitor magnesium, calcium, potassium, skin and eyes	Do not stop follow-up because the infusion stops	Monthly electrolytes, magnesium and calcium for two months after the last EGFR-antibody dose

The team arranges and reviews tests. This guide shows expected timing; it does not record completed appointments. National Cancer Control Programme (NCCP) 00207 v6 · official regimen

Tests in your plan

Carcinoembryonic antigen (CEA) — colorectal plans

If part of your plan

WHEN

For a colorectal cancer plan, if your team uses CEA; your team sets the interval.

A marker trend interpreted alongside symptoms, examination and scans.

Record the baseline, latest result and next date. A marker change alone does not establish progression.

THE WHOLE TREATMENT JOURNEY

Weekly cetuximab: treatment and checks

Selected metastatic colorectal cancer; or locally advanced head/neck cancer with radiotherapy when platinum is unsuitable

One larger first infusion is followed by weekly infusions. Bowel-cancer treatment continues while helping and tolerated. For head-and-neck treatment, cetuximab starts one week before radiotherapy and continues until radiation treatment finishes.

Read from left to right. Columns show stages, not equal lengths of time. This is a general plan: no dates or personal information are needed. Your team confirms which steps apply and arranges appointments.

Treatment, tests and reviews across the course

Care / check	Before starting	First treatment	During treatment	Phase / dose review	After treatment
Bloods and symptoms NCCP 00207	Baseline blood count, kidney and liver checks	Confirm tests and prescription before the first dose	Repeat bloods and symptom checks according to this regimen	Recheck after a hold or treatment change	Follow unresolved effects and the agreed disease-review plan
Treatment review NCCP 00207	Confirm exact cancer setting and biomarkers	Explain expected benefit and how it will be assessed	Report new symptoms between visits	Review response, tolerability and active medicines	Agree the next treatment or surveillance plan
Electrolytes and EGFR effects NCCP 00207	Check electrolyte and skin-risk plan	Skin care and prompt reaction reporting	Monitor magnesium, calcium, potassium, skin and eyes	Do not stop follow-up because the infusion stops	Monthly electrolytes, magnesium and calcium for two months after the last EGFR-antibody dose

What each check is for

1 A 7-day reference cycle

Clinic → home → review

For selected bowel cancer that has spread, cetuximab aims to control the cancer after previous treatments. For selected locally advanced head-and-neck cancer when platinum chemotherapy is unsuitable, it is combined with radiotherapy. Your team confirms which pathway applies.

Ask / act: Confirm the current phase, prescription, tests and support medicines.

Sources: NCCP 00207

At the next review, ask

- Which treatment phase am I in, and what happens next?
- Which test is expected next, who arranges it, and who explains the result?
- Who should I contact if an expected appointment has not arrived?

This map does not show whether a test has been ordered, booked or completed. Do not wait for a scheduled test if you develop new symptoms.

Sources checked 2026-11-05 · Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending · SACTCheck v0.84.34